

The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter



Photograph: NurPhoto via Getty Images

Anthropic, maker of the chatbot Claude, confidentially filed for an **initial public offering**. The firm, which was valued at \$900bn last week, said the filing “gives us the option” to eventually go public. SpaceX, which owns Grok, and, reportedly, OpenAI are already [preparing IPO plans](#). Earlier, Anthropic gave the EU’s cybersecurity agency access to its latest “**Mythos**” [model](#), according to Bloomberg.

Iran will halt indirect talks with America over Israel’s offensive in Lebanon, according to Iranian media. A “violation on one front” is a violation “on all fronts,” the country’s foreign minister posted on X. Donald Trump pushed back, claiming that talks were continuing “at a rapid pace”. The price of Brent crude rose by more than 5%. **America** and **Iran** exchanged strikes over the weekend.

Mr Trump said Binyamin Netanyahu, **Israel’s** prime minister, agreed to pull back troops that were preparing to attack **Beirut**, Lebanon’s capital. Earlier Mr Netanyahu ordered air strikes on the city’s southern suburbs, deemed to be under Hizbullah’s control. The Iran-backed militia fired more than 300 projectiles at Israel over the weekend. Mr Trump, after phone calls with both parties,

announced that “Israel will not attack them, and they will not attack Israel”.

America’s Justice Department said it will pull back from its \$1.8bn **“anti-weaponisation” fund**, amid resistance from Republican lawmakers threatening to derail the Trump administration’s legislative agenda. The government agreed to comply with a federal judge’s temporary pause on the programme, though it “disagrees strongly”. The fund was set up to compensate people claiming to have been targeted by previous administrations.

Barry Diller, an American media mogul, made a takeover bid for **MGM Resorts**, a **casino** operator. The offer values MGM at \$19bn with debt. Last week Tilman Fertitta, America’s ambassador to Italy, agreed to buy Caesars Entertainment, a rival of MGM, in an \$18bn deal. Las Vegas, home to both firms’ flagship casinos, has struggled since covid-19, but the legalisation of gambling elsewhere presents [new opportunities](#).

Nvidia, the world’s most valuable company, launched a new “superchip” for computers. Speaking at an event in Taiwan, Jensen Huang, the boss of the American [semiconductor-maker](#), said he wants to “reinvent the PC” for the age of artificial intelligence. The chip was developed with Microsoft and will see Nvidia compete directly with market leaders like AMD and Intel for the first time.

Shares of **Wise** fell after it was revealed that the British fintech is being investigated for money laundering offences. Belgian prosecutors are looking into €500m (\$583m) worth of transactions using Wise accounts, according to a report by the Bureau of Investigative Journalism. Wise said it is engaging with authorities and that the investigation is not indicative of any wrongdoing.

Figure of the day: 40,000, the number of people who buy *Country Life* magazine each week. Find out [why the British publication is thriving](#).



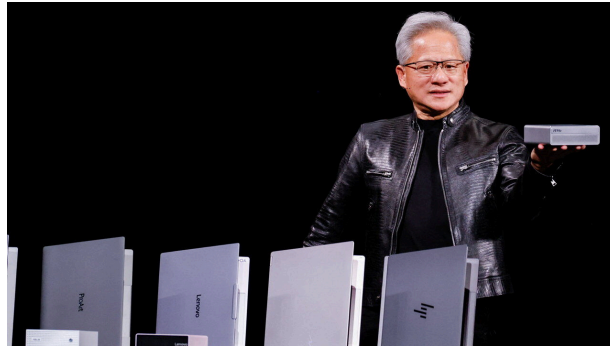
Photograph: Getty Images

Question time for Marco Rubio

America's secretary of state, who doubles as Donald Trump's [national security adviser](#), starts a tough two days in Congress on Tuesday. Marco Rubio will appear before four separate groups of lawmakers, including the influential Senate Foreign Relations Committee and House Foreign Affairs Committee. They are likely to press Mr Rubio on a range of topics. America and Iran exchanged missile strikes over the weekend, amid talks to end the war. Lawmakers will comb through the finer points of a nascent deal.

They are also concerned that the administration may be preparing to attack Cuba, whose former leader, Raúl Castro, America indicted recently. Mr Rubio is of Cuban heritage and has long taken a hawkish line on the island's regime. Taiwan is also likely to come up.

Mr Rubio is talked of as a contender for the Republican presidential nomination in 2028. The hearings will test his ability to preserve his credibility while selling Mr Trump's increasingly capricious foreign policy.



Photograph: Reuters

Nvidia brings AI to the PC

The [semiconductor company](#) best known for making the chips that power artificial-intelligence data centres is muscling in on the personal-computer business. This week at Computex, a big trade show in Taiwan, Jensen Huang, Nvidia’s boss, unveiled a chip that directly challenges Intel and AMD, two rival designers that dominate the market.

Nvidia is no stranger to the consumer market. Before the AI boom, it made most of its money selling graphics-processing units for gaming PCs. But the rise of “agentic” AI—in which systems carry out complex tasks on their own—is changing the hardware that personal computers need. Nvidia says its new design is the first aimed at running AI agents on PCs.

To support the move, Mr Huang has spent the past week wooing bosses of critical suppliers, including SK Hynix, a South Korean memory-maker, and TSMC, the Taiwanese chipmaking giant, over dinners around Taipei. These meals have become a spectator sport, with crowds gathering outside for a glimpse of Mr Huang, the chip industry’s poster boy.



Photograph: Alamy

Europe's inflation mystification

New data for the euro zone, released on Tuesday, will show that the increase in fuel costs caused by war in the Middle East is feeding through to prices elsewhere. Consequently, investors expect the European Central Bank to raise its main interest rate from 2% to 2.25% on June 11th.

But that is by no means certain. For a start, inflation does not seem to be growing rapidly, or evenly. Figures from France show the annual rate rose from 2.2% to 2.4% between April and May; in Germany it fell from 2.9% to 2.6%. And the ECB's latest inflation-expectations survey shows that, over the medium-term, consumers expect a rate of 2.9%, down from 3% a month earlier. Banks' lending standards have already tightened without any action by the ECB, in part because [economic growth](#) has taken a hit from the oil shock and made lending riskier. The ECB may want to wait and see.



Photograph: Reuters

Will the next governor of California please stand up?

The race to lead California is the state's most chaotic and consequential election in years. Term limits mean Gavin Newsom, the Democratic incumbent, cannot run again, and there is [no heir apparent](#) (largely because he has not endorsed anyone). In a primary on Tuesday, the top two, regardless of party, will advance to the general election in November.

Polling suggests that one Republican, Steve Hilton (a former adviser to David Cameron, a British prime minister), and two Democrats, Xavier Becerra (a former cabinet secretary for Joe Biden) and Tom Steyer (a climate-campaigning billionaire), have [the best chances](#). No Republican has won statewide in California since 2006; even if Mr Hilton makes it through, he is almost sure not to be elected. Mr Steyer's progressivism makes big business queasy and Mr Becerra rarely offers any plans at all. Democrats with experience in Sacramento, the state capital, or in local government have floundered. Mr Newsom may come to regret his silence.



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Tuesday: Casement, sash and bay are types of which architectural feature?

Monday: The British ships *HMS Erebus* and *HMS Terror* were lost in 1845 in the attempt to navigate which waterway?

*Women, like men, ought to have
their years so glutted with
freedom that they hate the very
idea of freedom.*

Vita Sackville-West